

Left (top to bottom) Filling and shaping individual tortellini by hand; *penne alla puttanesca*, with tomatoes, capers, olives, and chili peppers; using a dough scraper to cut gnocchi dusted with cornmeal

Below (top to bottom) Every pasta shape, plain or ridged, is designed to suit the texture of individual sauces; Vincenzo Conticello of the Antica Focacceria San Francesco in Sicily



SYDNEY, AUSTRALIA

Port of call since the 1800s for settlers from both southern and northern Italy, this vibrant cosmopolitan city has many modern trattorias offering a unique Australian fusion slant.

Café Sopra moderate

7 Danks St., Waterloo; www.fratellifresh.com.au

Expect to wait at this trendy restaurant on the light-filled floor above their market shop. An enticing blackboard menu offers simple heaven such as linguine with seafood, lemon, chili pepper, and garlic.

Dolcissimo moderate

96–8 Ramsay St., Haberfield; www.dolcissimo.com.au

Housed in a renovated shop in an old Italian neighborhood, Dolcissimo offers a wide choice of simple favorites, such as gnocchi with Gorgonzola and an outstanding *penne carbonara*.

ST. LOUIS, MO

This city's Italian community began to settle on "The Hill" in the early 1900s. A curious Italian-American dish developed here: toasted ravioli, deep-fried and served with a sauce.

Adriana's on the Hill inexpensive

5101 Shaw Ave.; www.adrianasonthehill.com

This friendly café is run by Adriana Fazio and her daughters, who produce Italian specials for lunch. The pasta is usually penne with a choice of tomato and basil, spicy *salsiccia* (pork sausage), or meatballs.

Da Marcella moderate

3600 Watson Rd.; www.trattoriamarcella.com

This well-established restaurant has a vast menu that embraces elegant *agnolotti del plin* (stuffed pasta with truffle butter), as well as the local favorite: toasted ravioli covered in tomato sauce.

NEW YORK, NY

New York has the most – and the most varied – Italian restaurants in the US, and they can call upon fresh Italian-sourced ingredients, flown in daily to the Big Apple.

Osteria del Circo moderate

120 W. 55th St.; www.osteriadelcirco.com

Sirio Maccioni's restaurant produces fabulous Tuscan food under the watchful eyes of his talented chef wife, Egidiana. This busy eatery serves traditional dishes such as *fritto misto di mare* (mixed, deep-fried fish) and modern Italian favorites like roasted scallops wrapped in pancetta. Don't miss "Mamma Egi's ravioli," stuffed with spinach and ricotta.

Patsy's moderate

236 W. 56th St.; www.patsys.com

Based in New York's theater district, Patsy's is a classic Italian eatery that attracts big-name actors and actresses as clientele. It's only had three chefs in its 65 years of existence, who faithfully reproduce its much-loved favorites – from *linguine puttanesca* and *tortellini bolognese* to striped bass *marechiaro* (poached in white wine, garlic, and tomato).

On the Menu

Aglia, olio, peperoncino Pasta simply dressed with garlic, olive oil, and chili pepper.

Ai frutti di mare, alla scogliera With mixed seafood and garlic.

Al nero di seppia With a black sauce of squid ink.

Alla norma With a rich Sicilian sauce of stewed eggplant, tomato, basil, and salted ricotta cheese.

Alle vongole With fresh clams.

Amatriciana A rich tomato sauce with bacon and sometimes chili peppers.

Bucatini Long, tubular pasta.

Cacio e pepe Melted Caciocavallo cheese and ground pepper.

Cannelloni Large pasta tubes filled with meat sauce or spinach and ricotta.

Capelli d'angelo Ultra-thin spaghetti.

Carbonara A creamy sauce of eggs, bacon, and Parmesan.

Fusilli Short, curly twists of pasta.

Gnocchi Small, soft dumplings of potato bound with a little flour.

Maccheroni General name for a wide range of short, tubular pasta.

Orechiette Dimpled buttons of pasta – also known as "small ears."

Pappardelle Wide ribbons of pasta.

Parmigiano Parmesan cheese.

Penne Short, quill-shaped tubes of pasta.

Puttanesca A type of sauce made with tomatoes, olives, and capers.

Ragù A rich meat and vegetable sauce.

Ravioli Flat pillows of pasta filled with meat, fish, vegetables, or cheese.

Spaghetti Long, round pasta.

Stringozzi Handmade Umbrian tagliatelle.

Tagliatelle Ribbons of pasta.

Trenette Like spaghetti but flatter and thicker, a Ligurian favorite with pesto.